

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM/SOAR | Threat Hunting | Vulnerability Management | Financial Services Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

A Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of progressive experience delivering enterprise-grade security operations within large, complex organisations. Specialist in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), threat hunting, and comprehensive vulnerability management. Brings a structured, risk-based approach to protecting sensitive data and critical business systems, with deep expertise in CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Kusto Query Language (KQL), and Privileged Access Management (PAM). Experienced in operating within regulated, high-compliance environments and communicating complex security risk to both technical teams and senior stakeholders. Committed to maintaining operational security excellence, refining detection capabilities, and continuously improving security posture in dynamic, fast-paced environments including the financial services sector.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **EDR/XDR Platforms:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover) - Expert; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender
- **SIEM/SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel with KQL, Splunk (Search Processing Language (SPL)), PowerShell-driven SOAR automation and playbook development
- **Threat Hunting and Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-based hunting, behavioural analytics, detection rule authoring, alert triage and investigation (L2/L3)
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory (Azure AD)), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Group Policy, BeyondTrust PAM
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, risk prioritisation and remediation coordination
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium, CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent
- **Email, Perimeter and Network Security:** Mimecast, Check Point Harmony firewall, Web Application Firewall (WAF), Data Loss Prevention (DLP)
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST 800-61 Incident Response, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Lead security operations across a complex, multi-site enterprise environment, managing SIEM, EDR, PAM, identity security, email security, endpoint management, and vulnerability management programmes.
- Administer the CrowdStrike Falcon platform (including Falcon Prevent, Falcon Insight EDR, Falcon Discover and Falcon NG-SIEM) as the organisation's primary EDR and extended detection and response (XDR) solution, configuring detection policies, response actions, and advanced hunting queries to protect all endpoints.
- Manage Microsoft Sentinel as the central SIEM, authoring KQL detection rules, scheduled analytics queries, and workbooks to provide continuous visibility into the threat landscape and enable rapid threat response.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting campaigns aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, investigating emerging threat actor techniques and tactics relevant to the education sector and producing actionable intelligence reports for senior leadership.

- Design and implement SOAR automation playbooks using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps to orchestrate alert enrichment, threat containment, and ticketing workflows, significantly reducing analyst workload and improving response times.
- Lead the incident response function in alignment with the NIST 800-61 framework, managing the full incident lifecycle from initial detection through containment, eradication, recovery and post-incident review.
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM, enforcing least-privilege access, managing privileged account lifecycle, and providing full session recording and audit trails for all privileged access.
- Manage vulnerability management operations using Pentra BAS, Tenable.io, AppCheck and Nessus, producing risk-based remediation plans and tracking closure of findings across IT and development teams.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) Conditional Access, MFA, SSO, and Group Policy, ensuring identity and access controls meet regulatory and internal policy requirements.
- Manage Mimecast email security, Check Point Harmony firewall policies, and Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM to maintain a strong perimeter and endpoint security posture.

University of the Arts London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Delivered L2 and L3 security alert triage and investigation, analysing and responding to threats surfaced by SIEM, EDR, and email security platforms across a 20,000-user organisation.
- Played a key role in the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user estate, managing onboarding, sensor configuration, exclusion policies and integration with Microsoft Sentinel.
- Conducted identity and access reviews in Azure AD, identifying stale accounts, over-privileged roles and misconfigurations, and coordinating remediation with the identity team.
- Produced vulnerability scan reports using Nessus and AppCheck, presenting risk findings to IT management and tracking remediation actions through to verified closure.
- Authored and tuned SIEM detection rules and correlation queries, improving signal-to-noise ratio and reducing false positive volumes to focus analyst capacity on genuine threats.
- Managed Mimecast anti-phishing and sandboxing policies, investigating targeted phishing and business email compromise (BEC) campaigns and implementing defensive controls to mitigate recurrence.
- Supported Cyber Essentials Plus certification, producing control evidence, conducting internal reviews, and coordinating with the external assessor to achieve certification.
- Maintained and improved MFA and Conditional Access policy configurations in Microsoft Entra ID, strengthening authentication controls across cloud and on-premises applications.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Managed IT security, infrastructure and quality assurance operations for a SaaS and Financial Technology (FinTech) software vendor, covering endpoint security, cloud access controls, network management, and IT service delivery.
- Deployed and maintained endpoint and perimeter security controls, including firewall policy management, endpoint protection tooling, and identity management in Azure AD.
- Conducted security risk assessments and gap analyses, producing remediation roadmaps aligned to ISO 27001 and cloud security best practice.
- Supported security incident identification and triage, applying structured investigative processes to contain and resolve security events with minimal business disruption.
- Provided IT infrastructure support across cloud (Azure) and on-premises environments, ensuring high availability and security of business-critical platforms.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the successful deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user estate at UAL, delivering comprehensive endpoint threat detection and enabling full integration with Microsoft Sentinel for unified security operations.
- Implemented CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across UAL's entire endpoint estate, establishing real-time behavioural detection, automated threat containment, and proactive threat hunting capability.

- Designed and deployed a library of SOAR automation playbooks that automated alert enrichment, Indicator of Compromise (IOC) lookups, and initial containment workflows, materially reducing Mean Time to Respond (MTTR).
- Deployed BeyondTrust PAM enterprise-wide, replacing unmanaged shared administrator credentials with fully audited, time-limited privileged sessions and reducing privileged access risk across the organisation.
- Integrated Pentera BAS into the vulnerability management programme to continuously simulate real-world attack techniques, enabling the team to proactively identify and close security gaps before threat actors could exploit them.
- Achieved Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL, coordinating multi-team evidence collection and achieving certification with no high-severity remediation items outstanding at assessment date.
- Developed MITRE ATT&CK-aligned KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel that improved high-fidelity alert generation, reduced Mean Time to Detect (MTTD), and provided clear threat visibility to senior stakeholders.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP85,000-95,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)